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The Court has recognized that First Amendment protection extends to corporations. *Bellotti*, *supra*, at 778, n. 14 (citing *Linmark Associates, Inc.* v. *Willingboro*, 431 U. S. 85 (1977); *Time, Inc.* v. *Firestone*, 424 U. S. 448 (1976); *Doran* v. *Salem Inn, Inc.*, 422 U. S. 922 (1975); *Southeastern Promotions, Ltd.* v. *Conrad*, 420 U. S. 546 (1975); *Cox Broadcasting Corp.* v. *Cohn*, 420 U. S. 469 (1975); *Miami Herald Publishing Co.* v. *Tornillo*, 418 U. S. 241 (1974); *New York Times Co.* v. *United States*, 403 U. S. 713 (1971) *(per curiam); Time, Inc.* v. *Hill*, 385 U. S. 374 (1967); *New York Times Co.* v. *Sullivan*, 376 U. S. 254; *Kingsley Int'l Pictures Corp.* v. *Regents of Univ. of N. Y.*, 360 U. S. 684 (1959); *Joseph Burstyn, Inc.* v. *Wilson*, 343 U. S. 495 (1952)); see, *e. g., Turner Broadcasting System, Inc.* v. *FCC*, 520 U. S. 180 (1997); *Denver Area Ed. Telecommunications Consortium, Inc.* v. *FCC*, 518 U. S. 727 (1996); *Turner*, 512 U. S. 622; *Simon & Schuster*, 502 U. S. 105; *Sable Communications of Cal., Inc.* v. *FCC*, 492 U. S. 115 (1989); *Florida Star* v. *B. J. F.*, 491 U. S. 524 (1989); *Philadelphia Newspapers, Inc.* v. *Hepps*, 475 U. S. 767 (1986); *Landmark Communications, Inc.* v. *Virginia*, 435 U. S. 829 (1978); *Young* v. *American Mini Theatres, Inc.*, 427 U. S. 50 (1976); *Gertz* v. *Robert Welch, Inc.*, 418 U. S. 323 (1974); *Greenbelt Cooperative Publishing Assn., Inc.* v. *Bresler*, 398 U. S. 6 (1970).

This protection has been extended by explicit holdings to the context of political speech. See, *e. g., Button*, 371 U. S., at 428–429; *Grosjean* v. *American Press Co.*, 297 U. S. 233, 244 (1936). Under the rationale of these precedents, political speech does not lose First Amendment protection "simply because its source is a corporation." *Bellotti*, *supra*, at 784; see *Pacific Gas & Elec. Co.* v. *Public Util. Comm'n of Cal.*, 475 U. S. 1, 8 (1986) (plurality opinion) ("The identity of the speaker is not decisive in determining whether speech is pro-